

## ITALY — STUDENT VISA AND RESIDENCE PERMIT GUIDE

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### 1. Study Courses

What types of courses allow a non-EU student to apply for a study visa?

Italy issues study visas to non-EU students enrolled in:

1. University programs (Bachelor's, Master's, PhD)
2. High-level Italian language courses lasting more than 90 days
3. Nationally recognized vocational/professional training courses (corsi di formazione professionale), including socio-health training
4. Short-term programs under 90 days (Type C visa)

The student must prove they will follow a course in an educational institution or professional training on a full-time basis, in line with their previous studies in their home country.

#### **Acceptable proof of course attendance:**

- Official letter of acceptance/enrollment from the Italian institution (on letterhead, stamped, stating course name, duration, and schedule)
- Pre-enrollment application validated through the University portal
- Enrollment letter from an accredited professional training entity (declaring accreditation to carry out professional training programs)
- Letter of enrollment from the home institution (for study abroad applicants), stating current student status and expected graduation date

#### **Governing law:**

- Legislative Decree No. 286/1998 — Consolidated Immigration Act (Testo Unico sull'Immigrazione)
- DPR No. 394/1999 — implementing regulation of the above

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### 2. Embassy Appointment

How to book an appointment at the Italian embassy?

Visit the website of the Italian consulate or embassy in your country and schedule a visa appointment. Some consulates use online booking platforms, while others may require

contacting them via email or phone. Appointments fill up fast, so it is a good idea to book yours as soon as you receive your acceptance letter.

### **Main platforms used to manage appointment bookings:**

- **Prenot@mi** ([prenotami.esteri.it](https://prenotami.esteri.it)) — the primary and official platform, centrally managed by the Italian Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International Cooperation; used for visas, passports, citizenship, and other consular services; adopted by most consulates worldwide since June 2021
- **VFS Global** — used by certain consulates as an alternative or supplementary channel, particularly for visa applications in specific countries

### **Key features of Prenot@mi:**

- Requires individual account registration with email verification
- Each applicant must have their own account (no shared family accounts)
- Appointments are released daily at midnight Rome time
- OTP (one-time password) verification required to confirm bookings
- Waiting list available when no slots are open
- Appointment confirmation required 3–10 days before the scheduled date

You can find your nearest Italian diplomatic mission via the official Visa for Italy portal: [vistoperitalia.esteri.it](https://vistoperitalia.esteri.it)

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## **3. Applying for a Study Visa**

What are the steps to apply for a study visa in Italy?

If you are a non-EU national planning to study in Italy for more than 90 days, you will need a national long-stay visa (Type D) for study purposes.

### **Steps:**

1. Get accepted into an accredited Italian institution
2. Pre-enroll via the University portal (for university programs)
3. Book an appointment at your local Italian consulate/embassy
4. Prepare and submit all required documents
5. Pay the visa fee and submit fingerprints

6. Wait for processing: **processing can take up to 90 days. Applicants are strongly advised to apply at least 3 months before their planned departure.**
  7. Collect your passport with the visa affixed
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#### **4. Documents Needed**

To apply for an Italy Student Visa (Type D), you must submit:

1. Valid passport (must be valid for at least three months beyond your intended stay and contain at least two blank pages)
2. Official letter of acceptance from an accredited Italian educational institution
3. Proof of accommodation in Italy (e.g., university housing confirmation, rental agreement, or host declaration)
4. Round-trip flight reservation or proof of travel itinerary
5. Visa application fee payment receipt
6. A cover letter or statement of purpose explaining your study plans in Italy

#### **Additionally:**

- Proof of financial means (bank statements)
- Health insurance valid for the entire stay
- Passport-size photos
- Pre-enrollment summary from the University portal (for university courses)

**Note:** all documents must be translated into Italian or English and may need to be legalized or apostilled depending on the country.

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#### **5. Money Requirements**

The foreign student must demonstrate being in possession of economic means for subsistence during the planned stay. The current minimum subsistence threshold set by the Italian Ministry of University and Research (MUR) for academic years 2025/2026 and 2026/2027 is:

**€534.41 per month = €6,947.33 per year (calculated over 13 monthly instalments)**

This can be proven through:

- Personal bank statements (covering the last 3–6 months, signed and stamped by the bank, not older than 30 days at time of submission)
- Parental or guardian bank statements, accompanied by a notarized sponsorship/affidavit letter confirming financial commitment, proof of relationship, and the sponsor's proof of employment or income
- A scholarship award letter from the Italian government, a recognized Italian university, or another official body, clearly stating the amount covered and duration
- A financial guarantee from an Italian institution, university, or a citizen legally residing in Italy
- An education loan sanction letter from an accredited bank, provided the funds are deposited and visible on submitted bank statements
- Income Tax Returns (ITR) of the sponsor, demonstrating consistent and legitimate income history
- Fixed deposit certificates, accompanied by bank confirmation of accessibility
- Proof of tuition fee payment in full (may reduce the remaining funds requirement)

**Notes:**

- All financial documents must be in Italian or English, or accompanied by a certified translation
- Documents must bear official bank stamps, letterheads, and authorized signatures
- Funds must reflect stable financial activity; sudden large deposits may trigger additional scrutiny
- Accepted sponsors are limited to: parents, legal guardians, Italian institutions, or foreign citizens legally residing in Italy

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## **6. Residence Permit (Permesso di Soggiorno)**

Non-EU foreigners holding a Type D (long-stay) study visa must apply for a **Permesso di Soggiorno per motivi di studio** within **8 working days** of arrival in Italy, as established by Art. 39 of Legislative Decree No. 286/1998 (Testo Unico sull'Immigrazione) and Arts. 44-bis, 45, and 46 of DPR No. 394/1999.

The permit is issued by the local Questura (Police Headquarters — Immigration Office) of the applicant's place of residence.

**Step-by-step procedure:**

1. Go to a Poste Italiane post office with a Sportello Amico counter within 8 working days of arrival
2. Request the free application kit (Kit Giallo — a large yellow-and-white envelope containing Mod. 209 Modulo 1 and Modulo 2)
3. Fill out the forms in black ink, block letters, in Italian; do not sign until in front of the postal officer
4. Attach the required documents and the marca da bollo; do not seal the envelope
5. Submit the kit in person at the Sportello Amico counter and pay the required fees
6. Receive a receipt with a UserID/password to track the application online; this receipt serves as proof of legal status until the permit is issued
7. Attend the fingerprinting appointment at the Questura on the date indicated on the postal receipt

**Documents needed for the kit (Mod. 209):**

1. Mod. 209 Modulo 1 filled out (for study purposes, only Modulo 1 is required; Modulo 2 is for employment-related permits)
2. Revenue stamp (marca da bollo) of €16.00, available at any tobacconist (tabaccaio) or newsagent
3. Photocopy of valid passport (data pages and study visa page)
4. Copy of the study programme, admission letter, or enrollment certificate, stamped by the Italian diplomatic/consular representation at the time the visa was issued
5. Proof of sufficient financial means (bank/post statement or certificate from institution confirming scholarship amount); minimum threshold is the annual Italian social allowance (€7,101.12 for 2026)
6. Copy of health/accident insurance policy valid in Italy for the entire duration of the permit (travel and tourist insurance policies are not accepted)
7. Copy of codice fiscale (Italian tax identification number) — not mandatory for first issue

**Fees payable at the post office:**

- €16.00 — marca da bollo

- €30.46 — electronic permit issuance fee (paid by postal giro slip included in the kit)
- €30.00 — postal service fee
- €40.00 — administrative contribution for permits of up to 1 year (total: €70.46 for the electronic permit + contribution, paid together)
- €50.00 — administrative contribution for permits of 1–2 years

**Legal basis:**

- Art. 39, Legislative Decree No. 286/1998 — governs residence permits for study purposes
- Arts. 44-bis, 45, and 46, DPR No. 394/1999 — implementing regulation on procedure and documentation

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## **7. Working While Studying**

With a valid Italy Student Visa and residence permit, you are allowed to work part-time — up to **20 hours per week** and **1,040 hours per year**. This applies to both employed and self-employed work. Hours exceeding this limit are not permitted under the student residence status.

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## **8. Renewing the Residence Permit**

Under Art. 5, para. 4 of Legislative Decree No. 286/1998, the renewal application must be submitted to the Questore of the province of residence **at least 60 days before** the permit's expiration date. The application is subject to verification of the same conditions required for the original issue. For study permits specifically, the procedure is governed by Art. 39 of D.Lgs. 286/1998 and Art. 46 of DPR 394/1999.

**Important notes on the deadline:**

- The renewal must be submitted before the expiration date, ideally at least 60 days before
- It may still be accepted up to 60 days after expiration in exceptional cases, but the applicant risks being considered irregularly present and may lose access to the National Health Service
- More than 60 days after expiration without a justified reason (giustificato motivo) will likely result in an irregular status

**Procedure:**

- Same as the first application — through a Poste Italiane Sportello Amico counter using the Kit Giallo (Mod. 209 Modulo 1; Modulo 2 only if the student also has income from work)
- On form Mod. 209, select option 8 (rinnovo) instead of 7 (rilascio)
- Same fees apply as for the first issue

**Additional documents required for renewal:**

- For university students: certificate proving the passing of at least 1 exam for the 1st renewal, and at least 2 exams for each subsequent renewal (Art. 46, DPR 394/1999); exceptions allowed only for serious health reasons or force majeure, duly documented
- For professional training students: documentation of continued enrollment from the accredited training institution
- Updated proof of financial means for the duration of the renewed permit
- Updated health/accident insurance policy valid in Italy for the renewed period
- Updated university enrollment certificate (certificato di iscrizione)
- Copy of the current (expiring) permit

**Legal status during processing:**

- Under Art. 5, para. 9 of D.Lgs. 286/1998, the permit must be issued or renewed within 60 days of the application; in practice, processing takes 90–180 days or more
- The postal receipt (ricevuta) serves as proof of legal status until the new permit is issued and must always be carried with the expired permit
- Travel to other Schengen countries during this period is not permitted with the receipt alone; direct travel to the country of citizenship is allowed

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## **9. Changing to a Work Permit**

Yes. A study residence permit can be converted into either a work permit or a self-employment permit. It is possible to convert a residence permit for study through an application addressed telematicamente to the Prefecture competent for the place of work. With the entry into force of the Cutro Decree, it is possible to submit applications for conversion at any time of the year, with no limit on the number.

Alternatively, Italy offers international students who have completed their studies the ability to remain in the country and search for employment through a residence permit

specifically designed for job-seeking purposes — allowing you to legally remain in Italy for up to 12 months while seeking employment or starting a business after graduation.

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## 10. Official Information

| Resource                                   | URL                                                                       |
|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Visa for Italy (MFA)                       | <a href="https://vistoperitalia.esteri.it">vistoperitalia.esteri.it</a>   |
| University (pre-enrollment portal)         | <a href="https://universitaly.it">universitaly.it</a>                     |
| EU Immigration Portal — Italy              | <a href="https://home-affairs.ec.europa.eu">home-affairs.ec.europa.eu</a> |
| Ministry of Universities & Research        | <a href="https://mur.gov.it">mur.gov.it</a>                               |
| Police HQ (Questura) for residence permits | <a href="https://poliziadistato.it">poliziadistato.it</a>                 |

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## 11. Application Forms

1. Visa application form: Available at your local Italian consulate website or at [vistoperitalia.esteri.it](https://vistoperitalia.esteri.it)
  2. University pre-enrollment: [universitaly.it](https://universitaly.it)
  3. Permesso di Soggiorno kit (Mod. 209): Available at any Italian post office (Poste Italiane) or downloadable from [poliziadistato.it](https://poliziadistato.it)
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## 12. Tips for Students

| Mistake                                  | How to Avoid                                                              |
|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Booking the embassy appointment too late | Book immediately after receiving your acceptance letter — slots fill fast |
| Incomplete or untranslated documents     | Prepare everything in Italian or English; apostille where required        |



**Mistake****How to Avoid**

Insufficient funds in bank account

Ensure at least €6,947.33 is clearly visible in bank statements ( $€534.41 \times 13$  months)

Missing the 8-day deadline for residence permit

Apply for the Permesso di Soggiorno at a post office within 8 working days of arriving in Italy

Not pre-enrolling on University

Complete the University pre-enrollment before visiting the consulate

Letting the permit expire without renewal

Start the renewal process at least 60 days before expiration